

REG-04: Prior Authorization in 2026, Industry Context

Compiled from public sources; see the source list in the case study.

- KFF's August 2026 analysis of the first public CMS-mandated metrics found insurers denied 12% (Medicare Advantage), 14% (Medicaid managed care) and 18% (ACA marketplace) of standard prior authorization requests in 2025.
- Few denials are appealed, but many appeals succeed: KFF reported overturn rates of 67% in Medicare Advantage, 47% in Medicaid managed care and 43% in the marketplace.
- An AMA survey found practices completed an average of 39 prior authorizations per physician per week in 2024, with about 13 staff hours a week spent on them.
- In June 2025, around 50 insurers made voluntary commitments to streamline prior authorization, including processing a large share of electronic approvals in real time.
- High-profile controversies over algorithmic denials have driven bipartisan state legislation requiring clinician review of AI-assisted denials.